These objectives have been largely achieved. A first set of chapters considers the categories of imperialism, sub-imperialism and capital-imperialism.

- Patrick Bond discusses how sub-imperialism has emerged as a theoretical category, with a focus on the characteristics of semi-peripheral accumulation, hinterland exploitation, internal modes of super-exploitation and the reproduction of a world system based on neoliberalism and military aggression.
- Mathias Luce revisits Ruy Mauro Marini's formulations within the Marxist theory of dependency, and he develops a comprehensive theory of sub-imperialism as the 'highest stage of dependent capitalism'. This results in a new hierarchy in the world system, with intermediate links in the imperialist chain, a position held especially by Brazil, South Africa and India. According to Luce, however, China and Russia cannot be characterised similarly.
- Virginia Fontes is already working with a new category, 'capital-imperialism', in order to understand transformations of contemporary capitalism and its new economic, political and social contradictions. For Fontes, the dominance exercised by the core countries must be understood not as something external, but internalised in other countries, with BRICS countries revealing a subordinate membership within capital-imperialist expansion.
- Leo Panitch provides the perspective on imperialism which he and Sam Gindin have pioneered, in which older theories of inter-imperial rivalry and capital export have less relevance in view of the post-War centrality of US institutions. These still define the scope for all other actors, including the BRICS. If the BRICS are less easy to incorporate than Washington's G7 allies, Panitch is also interested in their internal contestations, including Chinese, Brazilian and South African class struggles.
- Claudio Katz analyses the general status of what he calls emerging, intermediate and peripheral neoliberalism. Katz scans the BRICS as well as Turkey and other countries in the process of emergence. He stresses, especially, contradictions within semi-peripheral capitalism, and considers food price inflation and the super-exploitation of labour to have great importance, perhaps setting the stage for new revolts linking production and social reproduction processes.

These attempts to set the global context lead us to a second set of chapters on corporate and political expansion of BRICS in Africa and Latin America, the sites of our utmost concern in 2013–14 due to the regional 'gateway' claims of the